

INDIA 2026-27 EDITION

THE ROOFTOP SOLAR PLAYBOOK



PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana

How to claim up to Rs. 78,000 in central subsidy (plus your state's top-up), pick a vendor who will not vanish, and get the money into your bank account without the rejections and delays.

A complete, source-verified field guide to India's largest ever rooftop solar scheme — from reading your electricity bill to the day the subsidy lands.

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About this playbook

This is a practical, step-by-step guide to installing rooftop solar at home under the Government of India's PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana. It is written for the person who actually has to do the work: a homeowner who wants a smaller electricity bill, a subsidy in the bank, and a system that keeps working for twenty-five years.

Everything here is built from official sources — the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) scheme guidelines, Press Information Bureau releases, the National Portal at pmsuryaghar.gov.in, the Electricity (Rights of Consumers) Rules, and the published rate sheets of public-sector banks. Where a number is an estimate rather than an official figure, we say so plainly. Where a rule can change, we tell you exactly where to re-check it before you sign anything.

The scheme is genuinely generous, and it is also genuinely easy to get wrong. Most failures are not technical — they are process failures. Installing before feasibility approval, choosing an unregistered vendor, or missing a name-match between your Aadhaar and your electricity bill can cost you the entire subsidy. This playbook exists to stop that happening to you.

The single most important deadline in this book

PM Surya Ghar is a time-bound scheme. Its guidelines run until **31 March 2027**, and its stated target is one crore households. It has already crossed 60 lakh installations. Subsidy is paid from a fixed national outlay, first-come, first-served. If solar is on your list, the cost of waiting is not zero.

How to use it

Read Part 1 to decide whether solar makes sense for your home and your bill. Work through Part 2 to size your system and understand what a fair quote looks like. Keep Part 3 open beside you while you fill the portal form. Use Part 4 before you talk to a bank. Read Part 5 before you pay anyone a single rupee. Part 6 is what happens after the panels go up.

A note on money and decisions

This playbook explains how the scheme, the subsidy and the loans work, and the trade-offs between them. It is not financial or legal advice, and it is not an installer. Solar is a large, long-term purchase: get at least three quotes, read every contract before signing, and confirm current subsidy amounts and rules on the official portal, because they are revised from time to time.

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PART 1

Why now

1. The 2026 solar moment

PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana is the largest residential rooftop solar programme in the world. It was approved by the Union Cabinet on 29 February 2024 with an outlay of Rs. 75,021 crore, launched on 13 February 2024, and is designed to put solar on one crore Indian homes by 31 March 2027. In simple terms: the government pays a large chunk of the cost of your panels, straight into your bank account, and you get a smaller electricity bill for the next twenty-five years.

The scheme has moved from a slow start to a sprint. It took 118 days to reach its first one lakh households; it now adds one lakh households every six days. July 2026 was the biggest month yet, with 5.06 lakh households benefitting — roughly 16,328 installations a day, against 5,038 a day in October 2025.

60 lakh+

HOMES SO FAR

Rooftop systems installed under the scheme by October 2026

Rs. 33,642 cr

SUBSIDY PAID

Transferred directly to beneficiaries' bank accounts

1 crore

THE TARGET

Households by 31 March 2027 — the scheme's deadline

Why the window matters

Two features of the scheme create real urgency. First, it is time-bound: the guidelines run only until 31 March 2027. Second, the subsidy is paid from a fixed national budget on a first-come, first-served basis. States operate their own top-up budgets on the same logic. This is not a scheme that will quietly wait for you.

There is a third reason the timing is good. The scheme has been simplified through 2025 and 2026. Technical feasibility approval has been waived for systems up to 10 kW, the sanctioned-load cap has been raised automatically up to 10 kW, the net-metering agreement has been folded into the portal application itself, and over eighty DISCOMs are now integrated with the National Portal. What used to be a months-long paper chase is now, for most homes, a mostly online process.

What 'Muft Bijli' really means

The scheme aims to give participating households up to **300 units of free electricity a month** through net metering — you generate your own power by day and export the surplus to the grid, offsetting what you draw at night. For a household consuming up to about 300 units a month, a 3 kW system can broadly wipe out the bill. It is 'free' in the sense that your own generation cancels your consumption — not that electricity arrives from nowhere.

The reality check

Roughly 20.7 lakh households under the scheme now record zero electricity bills, and more than 12 lakh households earned about Rs. 421 crore in FY 2024-25 by selling surplus power back to the grid — around Rs. 3,500 a year for those exporting. Those are the two outcomes worth aiming for: a near-zero bill, and a small income from what you do not use.

2. What the scheme actually pays

The central subsidy is called Central Financial Assistance, or CFA. It is fixed by the size of your system, not by your income or your bill, and it is paid after the system is installed and inspected. Here is the structure, straight from the MNRE guidelines.

System size	How the subsidy is calculated	You receive (central)
1 kW	60% of benchmark cost, first 2 kW	Rs. 30,000
2 kW	60% of benchmark cost, first 2 kW	Rs. 60,000
3 kW	Rs. 30,000 x 2 + Rs. 18,000 x 1 (the third kW)	Rs. 78,000
4 kW and above	Capped at the 3 kW level	Rs. 78,000 (no more)

The benchmark cost the government uses is Rs. 50,000 per kW for the first two kW and Rs. 45,000 for the third. In the special-category states and regions — Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, the North-Eastern states including Sikkim, and the island UTs of Andaman & Nicobar and Lakshadweep — the benchmark is higher (Rs. 55,000 and Rs. 49,500), so the effective subsidy is higher too: Rs. 33,000 per kW for the first two kW and Rs. 19,800 for the third.

A few things people get wrong

The cap is real. A 5 kW or a 10 kW system receives exactly the same Rs. 78,000 as a 3 kW one. There is no extra central subsidy for going bigger — a bigger system may still make sense, but you are paying for the extra capacity yourself.

It is a per-kWp figure, not a per-inverter figure. The subsidy follows the rated DC capacity of your solar modules, whatever inverter you fit.

Group housing societies and RWAs are eligible too, for common facilities including EV charging, at Rs. 18,000 per kWp up to 500 kWp (roughly 3 kWp per house).

Off-grid systems do not qualify. Neither do commercial, industrial or government connections. The subsidy is for residential grid-connected systems.

No income limit. Any residential household with a valid grid connection can apply. The only bar is having already taken a central solar subsidy for the same connection.

The one-line summary

For a typical home, install a **3 kW system**. It is the exact size at which the central subsidy stops growing, which is why 3 kW is the most installed residential capacity in India.

3. The real maths: cost, subsidy, savings, payback

The subsidy is only half the story. What matters is what you pay out of pocket and how fast it comes back. The tables below use common Indian benchmarks — roughly Rs. 50,000 to Rs. 70,000 per kW installed, about 4 units generated per kW per day, and a tariff of about Rs. 8 per unit. Your own quote, city and tariff will differ; use these to sense-check a vendor's numbers, not to replace them.

Size	Approx. gross cost	Central subsidy	Net cost to you	Units / month	Approx. payback
1 kW	Rs. 55,000 - 70,000	Rs. 30,000	Rs. 25,000 - 40,000	110 - 140	2.5 - 3 years
2 kW	Rs. 1.1 - 1.3 lakh	Rs. 60,000	Rs. 50,000 - 70,000	220 - 280	2.5 - 3 years
3 kW	Rs. 1.7 - 2.0 lakh	Rs. 78,000	Rs. 92,000 - 1.22 lakh	330 - 420	3 - 4 years
5 kW	Rs. 2.5 - 3.0 lakh	Rs. 78,000	Rs. 1.7 - 2.2 lakh	550 - 700	4 - 5 years

Figures are indicative planning estimates, not quotes. System cost, tariff and generation vary by state, roof and vendor.

A worked example

Suppose your bill is about Rs. 3,000 a month, which at Rs. 8 a unit is about 375 units. You need a system that generates roughly that much, which is about 3 kW. At Rs. 60,000 per kW, the gross cost is about Rs. 1,80,000. Subtract the Rs. 78,000 subsidy and your net cost is about Rs. 1,02,000. The system saves you roughly Rs. 2,880 a month, or about Rs. 34,560 a year. That pays back the net cost in about three years — and the panels keep generating for around twenty-five.

The 25-year view

A solar panel's warranted life is about 25 years, and the government's own calculation assumes exactly that. Even if you ignore rising tariffs and the subsidy entirely, a well-chosen system typically returns its net cost several times over within its life. The subsidy simply shortens the payback and improves the return.

What the government itself promises

The PIB has stated that a household consuming up to 300 units a month, installing a 3 kW system, is assured of saving approximately Rs. 15,000 a year on its electricity bill. Treat that as the conservative official figure — your actual saving depends on your tariff and how much you export.

4. Is your home ready?

Before you spend an afternoon on the portal, spend five minutes checking that your home qualifies. These are the things that quietly disqualify people.

Check	What qualifies	Why it matters
Connection type	A domestic / residential grid connection from your DISCOM	Commercial, industrial and government connections get no subsidy at all
Ownership	You own the house, or hold terrace rights (as in many flats)	The subsidy is tied to the property and the connection
Roof	A shadow-free roof, terrace, balcony or elevated structure	Shading from trees or taller buildings cuts generation sharply
Load	Your sanctioned load can cover the system size	The system cannot exceed your sanctioned load without a load enhancement
Prior subsidy	No central solar subsidy already claimed on this connection	Double-dipping on the same property is not allowed

Sizing your roof

A rough rule of thumb is about 100 square feet of shadow-free roof per kW. A 1 kW system needs roughly 80 to 100 sq ft; a 3 kW system needs about 300 sq ft. South-facing roofs generate the most, but east- and west-facing roofs work too. If your only usable roof is north-facing or heavily shaded for much of the day, a vendor's honest savings estimate will be lower — and so should your expectations be.

The load question

Every electricity connection has a sanctioned load — the maximum you are allowed to draw, shown on your bill. Your solar system's capacity generally cannot exceed it. The good news is that under the 2026 simplifications, sanctioned load can now be raised automatically up to 10 kW as part of the application, so a home that could only support 2 kW a year ago can often apply for 3 kW or more today.

Watch for a DISCOM moratorium

A small number of DISCOMs, mostly in congested urban grids, have paused new net-metering connections. Before you commit, check whether your DISCOM is accepting new applications. Your chosen vendor will usually know, but the authoritative answer is your DISCOM or the National Portal.

The verdict

If you own your home, have a domestic connection, and have a reasonably sunny roof, you almost certainly qualify. The rest of this playbook is about doing it correctly.

PART 2

Sizing and choosing

5. Reading your bill to size your system

The single biggest sizing mistake is guessing. Your electricity bill tells you almost everything you need. Find the line that shows your consumption in units (kWh) for the last few months, and note your tariff slab, which is the rate you pay per unit.

Get your average monthly units. Add up the last three to six months of consumption and divide. Use a full year if you can, because summer air-conditioning spikes consumption.

Divide by about 120. A 1 kW system generates roughly 120 units a month in most of India (about 4 units a day). So 360 units a month points to a 3 kW system.

Cap at the subsidy sweet spot unless you have a reason. If your consumption suggests 4 kW but your budget is tight, a 3 kW system captures the full Rs. 78,000 and covers most of a typical bill.

Do not oversize for the subsidy. Past 3 kW the central subsidy stops, and exporting far more than you use earns only a modest credit. Size to your consumption first.

Appliance reality check

A 1 kW system comfortably runs lights, fans, a fridge, a TV and a washing machine. It will not run a 1.5-tonne air-conditioner, a large water pump or an electric geyser on a regular basis — those loads either need a 2 to 3 kW system or will consume the entire generation the moment they switch on.

If your home runs...	You likely need
Lights, fans, TV, fridge, occasional washing machine	1 - 2 kW
The above plus one air-conditioner, or a geyser	3 kW
Two air-conditioners, or an EV charger at home	4 - 5 kW

6. Choosing the right system

Solar systems come in three broad types. For a subsidy, you want the grid-connected kind.

Type	How it works	Subsidy?	Best for
On-grid (grid-tied)	Panels feed the grid via a net meter; no battery	Yes	Most homes — cheapest and simplest
Hybrid	Panels plus a battery, still grid-connected	Yes (with conditions)	Homes wanting backup during outages
Off-grid	Panels plus battery, no grid connection	No	Remote sites with no reliable grid

Behind-the-meter hybrid systems can qualify for the subsidy, subject to approval by your state regulator, but pure off-grid systems do not. For a typical urban or semi-urban home with a working grid connection, on-grid is the right answer.

The two lists that decide your subsidy: ALMM and DCR

This is where a lot of claims die, and it is worth understanding properly.

ALMM List-I is the MNRE's Approved List of Models and Manufacturers for solar *modules*. Your panels must be on it.

ALMM List-II covers solar *cells* — the layer inside the module. From 1 June 2026, PM Surya Ghar requires modules built with List-II-approved cells.

DCR is the Domestic Content Requirement: subsidised installations must use domestically-made modules.

Verify the exact model number on the MNRE website, not on a certificate the vendor sends you. ALMM listing is model-specific, not brand-wide, and certificate PDFs are trivially forged.

The 'Give It Up' option

If a household chooses to forgo the central subsidy entirely — the 'Give It Up' route — it is exempt from the ALMM List-II cell rule until 31 March 2027. This is a relief valve for stock that does not meet the new cell rule. It only makes sense if you have decided, in writing, that you do not want the subsidy. Most buyers should simply insist on fully ALMM-compliant equipment.

The inverter and the rest of the kit

Your inverter must be grid-tied, BIS-certified, and meet MNRE technical standards, including anti-islanding protection. Ask for the exact inverter model and check its certification. Balance-of-system items — mounting structure, DC and AC cabling, earthing, surge protection — are where cheap installations cut corners, and where safety problems hide.

7. Net metering, in plain English

Net metering is what makes the economics work. Without it, you would only save money on the power you use while the sun is up. With it, your daytime surplus is credited against your night-time consumption.

Here is the mechanism. A bidirectional net meter replaces your ordinary meter. When your panels make more than your home is using, the surplus flows to the grid and the meter runs backwards. When the sun goes down and you draw from the grid, you spend those credits. Over a billing period, you pay only for your net consumption — and if you exported more than you used, you may be paid or credited for the difference, depending on your state.

Question	The answer
Who decides the rules?	Not MNRE. Net metering is a Ministry of Power and state regulator subject. Your State Electricity Regulatory Commission sets the metering, banking and settlement terms.
How much can be net-metered?	The Electricity (Rights of Consumers) Amendment Rules, 2021 permit net metering up to 500 kW, or your sanctioned load, whichever is lower. State rules can be tighter.
Can surplus be banked?	In most states, yes — exported units are credited and carried forward within limits set by the state regulator.
How is surplus paid?	Rules vary. Some states pay for exported surplus; others only credit it against consumption. Check your state's tariff order.

Two identical systems in two different states can settle surplus on different terms. That is not a flaw in the scheme — it is federalism. Read your own state's rules before you size your system, because they change the payback.

The one number to remember

The net meter is on the critical path. No net meter means no commissioning certificate, and no commissioning certificate means no subsidy. The meter wait commonly runs from a couple of weeks to about six weeks depending on your DISCOM. Chase it proactively — do not assume your installer is doing it for you.

PART 3

The application, step by step

8. Documents to gather first

Gather everything before you open the portal. Applications stall because a document is missing, and a stalled application is a delayed subsidy.

Document	What it is for	Watch out for
Aadhaar card	Identity and DBT linkage	Name must match your bill exactly
Latest electricity bill	Consumer number, DISCOM, tariff category	Use the most recent bill; old consumer IDs can fail
Bank account + cancelled cheque	Where the subsidy lands	Account must be Aadhaar-seeded or DBT will fail
Property ownership proof	Confirms you own the premises	Sale deed, property tax receipt, or terrace-rights proof
Mobile number (Aadhaar-linked)	OTP verification	Update it at your DISCOM if it has changed
Passport-size photograph	Portal registration	Standard photo
PAN card	KYC for some banks and loans	Needed if you take a loan

The name-match trap

The name on your Aadhaar must match the name on your electricity bill. Even small differences — initials versus a full name, a spelling variation — cause automated rejection. If they do not match, get the bill name corrected at your DISCOM office *before* you apply. This single check prevents more rejections than any other.

9. The portal walkthrough

The whole application runs through the National Portal at **pmsuryaghar.gov.in**. Registration and application are free. There is no processing fee, no file charge, and no 'slot reservation' fee — anyone who asks for money to process your subsidy is a scammer.

Register. Go to pmsuryaghar.gov.in and choose 'Apply for Rooftop Solar'. Enter your state, your DISCOM and your consumer number exactly as printed on your bill. Verify with the OTP sent to your Aadhaar-linked mobile, then create a password.

Submit your application. Fill in roof area, roof direction, shading and your average monthly consumption, and choose your system capacity. The portal shows the eligible subsidy for that size. Upload your documents and submit.

Feasibility. For systems up to 10 kW, technical feasibility is deemed accepted — you generally do not wait for a manual DISCOM study. Where your state has not yet operationalised this, you may be asked to upload documents and wait as per state rules.

Choose a registered vendor. From the portal's vendor list for your state and DISCOM, contact several registered installers and get quotes. Confirm the vendor you pick is active on the portal.

Install. The vendor installs the system using ALMM-listed modules and a compliant inverter, and files the net-metering request.

Update the portal. After installation, update the system details on the portal and upload the required documents, including geo-tagged photographs. Your vendor can assist from your login.

Inspection and net meter. Your DISCOM inspects the installation against a checklist, signs the metering agreement and installs the bidirectional net meter.

Commissioning certificate and subsidy. Once the net meter is in and the system is live, the portal generates a commissioning certificate. Upload it with your bank details and cancelled cheque. The subsidy is released to your account.

The official clocks

MNRE fixes only two timelines: Central Financial Assistance is processed within **15 days of DISCOM approval**, and grievances raised through the portal are to be resolved within **30 days**. Everything else — feasibility, inspection, net meter — runs on state and DISCOM timelines. End to end, most installations take roughly 60 to 90 days from application to subsidy; some close in 45, and complex cases take longer.

10. Feasibility and the 10 kW deemed-approval rule

This rule is the reason the 2026 process is so much faster than it used to be, and it is worth understanding because vendors sometimes still describe the old process.

Under the Electricity (Rights of Consumers) Rules, 2020, applications for rooftop solar systems up to 10 kW capacity are **deemed to have been accepted without requiring approval of technical feasibility** by the DISCOM. In plain terms: for a home system, you do not have to wait in a queue for a manual feasibility study. The connection is presumed grid-ready unless your DISCOM raises a specific, justified objection.

Two caveats keep this honest. First, the rule applies only where your state regulator or DISCOM has operationalised it; until then, you upload documents and wait as per state rules. Second, deemed feasibility does not remove the sanctioned-load check. If your proposed system is bigger than your sanctioned load, you still need a load enhancement first — which is now automatic up to 10 kW as part of the application.

What to say if a vendor tells you otherwise

If an installer insists you must 'wait months for feasibility approval' or offers to 'get your feasibility cleared quickly' for a fee, be careful. For systems up to 10 kW the rule is deemed acceptance. Fees for something the government does not charge are a red flag, not a service.

The e-token

When you submit your application, the portal generates an e-token. This is the mechanism through which the subsidy is released. After your documents are uploaded and the DISCOM inspection is complete, the e-token is redeemed against the eligible CFA amount. If you took a loan, the subsidy is first applied to the loan account up to the outstanding amount, with any remainder paid to your bank account. Keep your e-token visible on your portal profile.

11. Choosing and vetting a vendor

This is the decision that most affects whether you actually get your subsidy and whether your system lasts. Only vendors registered on the National Portal can be used if you want the subsidy. An unregistered installer disqualifies the whole claim, however good the work.

As of 2026 there are over 34,000 registered vendors nationally, of whom about 29,000 are active. That is plenty of choice — and it means you never need to accept the first quote you are given.

Your vetting checklist

Confirm registration. Check the vendor appears in the portal's vendor list for your state and DISCOM, and note their registration ID.

Get at least three quotes. Compare the exact module brand and model, the inverter brand and model, the mounting structure, and what is included in the price.

Verify ALMM, at the model level. Open the current ALMM list on the MNRE website and match the exact model number on the quote. Do this again at delivery, against the nameplate on the actual equipment.

Ask for GST and a physical address. A genuine business has both. Be wary of a vendor who only offers a mobile number and cash payment.

Insist on a written quotation and contract. It should name the system size, the equipment, the payment schedule, the warranty, and who handles the net-metering paperwork.

Never pay a large advance. A small booking amount after verification is reasonable; 70 to 100 percent up front is how people get burned.

Ask about the five-year maintenance contract. Under the MNRE vendor framework, a comprehensive maintenance obligation applies. Get it in writing.

The rule of thumb on money

Pay in milestones: a modest booking amount after you have verified the vendor, a larger payment after materials arrive at your site, and the balance after installation and commissioning. Pay by bank transfer or UPI to the company's official account — never cash to a technician.

12. Installation day

A standard residential installation takes one to three days. It is worth being present, or having someone you trust present, because what you can see on the day is what you cannot easily fix later.

Match the nameplates. Check that the module and inverter models installed are exactly the ones quoted and ALMM-verified.

Look at the mounting structure. It should be galvanised, securely anchored, and tilted for your latitude. A flimsy structure is the most common future failure.

Check earthing and surge protection. Proper earthing and a surge protection device are safety essentials, not optional extras.

Cable routing and DC/AC wiring. Neat, protected, and rated for the job. Exposed or undersized cabling is a defect.

Geo-tagged photographs. The portal requires geo-tagged photos of the installed system. Make sure your vendor takes and uploads them.

Get the paperwork. Installation invoice, module and inverter warranty documents, and the net-metering application acknowledgement.

Do not start before feasibility

Do not let any vendor begin installation before feasibility is approved (or deemed, for systems up to 10 kW). Installing first and applying afterwards is the fastest way to lose the subsidy. If a vendor pushes you to start before the portal shows approval, that is a warning sign about the vendor, not a shortcut.

13. Net meter, inspection and commissioning

After installation, three things have to happen before you can claim the subsidy: a DISCOM inspection, the net-meter installation, and the commissioning certificate. This is the stage where most delays occur, and where you should be most proactive.

Raise the net-metering request. Your vendor files it through the portal; the DISCOM schedules an inspection of the completed installation.

Inspection. A DISCOM technician checks the installation against a safety and quality checklist. A clean inspection moves you forward; a failed one returns the file for correction.

Net-meter installation. The DISCOM replaces your meter with a bidirectional net meter. In areas with smart metering under the RDSS programme, the meter comes through the appointed metering service provider.

Commissioning certificate. Once the net meter is installed and the system is live, the portal issues a commissioning certificate. This is the document that unlocks your subsidy.

Why this stage drags

Inspection and metering run on state and DISCOM capacity, which varies widely. Field experience puts the net-meter wait at anywhere from about two weeks to six weeks, and it can be longer in high-demand periods. Because the commissioning certificate is only issued after the meter is in, every day of meter delay is a day your subsidy cannot move. Follow up after three to four weeks if you have not heard back.

Track it yourself

Do not rely on your installer's word. Log in to the portal and read your own application status. Know which stage you are at, and chase the next one. A vendor who goes quiet after installation is the single most common complaint — and the reason Part 5 exists.

14. Claiming the subsidy

This is the finish line, and it is short. Once you have the commissioning certificate, you are one upload away from your money.

Log in and upload the commissioning certificate — a scanned PDF or a clear photograph is accepted.

Enter your bank details and cancelled cheque. The name on the account should match the electricity connection. If you took a loan, give the loan account details.

Redeem the e-token. This triggers the release of the eligible CFA amount.

Receive the subsidy. MNRE processes the CFA within 15 days of DISCOM approval. In practice, budget for a few weeks; if the subsidy exceeds your outstanding loan, the remainder is paid to your bank account.

Stage	Typical time
Portal registration and application	Same day
Feasibility (deemed for up to 10 kW)	Immediate to a few days
Vendor selection and installation	1 - 2 weeks
Inspection and net-meter installation	2 - 6 weeks (DISCOM-dependent)
Commissioning certificate to subsidy in bank	A few weeks
Total, application to subsidy	Typically 60 - 90 days

Keep every document — invoice, warranty papers, the commissioning certificate and your payment proof — until the subsidy is credited. You may need them if processing is delayed.

PART 4

Paying for it

15. Solar loans and Jan Samarth

You do not have to fund the system from savings. The scheme envisages standardised, low-interest loans, and most public-sector banks offer them. The model product is collateral-free, benchmarked to the RBI repo rate plus 50 basis points.

With the repo rate at 5.25 percent, that benchmark works out to about **5.75 percent per annum** for loans up to Rs. 2 lakh — the rate most PSBs currently publish. The process runs through the government's **Jan Samarth** portal: you register on the National Portal first, then apply for the loan, and the bank pays your registered vendor directly.

Feature	The model terms
Interest (up to Rs. 2 lakh)	About 5.75% p.a., floating, linked to repo + 50 bps
Interest (Rs. 2 - 6 lakh)	Roughly 7.90% and up, bank- and CIBIL-dependent
Collateral	None up to Rs. 2 lakh; the system is the security
Margin	Typically about 10% of project cost
Tenure	Up to 10 years, including a moratorium of around 6 months
Processing fee	Often nil up to Rs. 2 lakh
Disbursement	Directly to your registered vendor

How a loan interacts with the subsidy

If you finance the system, the subsidy is first applied to your loan account up to the outstanding balance, and any remainder is paid to your bank account. In effect, the government pays down your loan. Ask your bank to confirm this at sanction.

Do not quote a single rate as a promise

These rates are floating and move with the repo rate, and banks set their own terms. Treat any figure here as a starting point and confirm the live rate on your chosen bank's page and on your sanction letter before you sign.

16. Your state's top-up subsidy

Several states add their own subsidy on top of the central Rs. 78,000. This is the most under-used lever in the scheme, because most buyers do not know it exists. State top-ups are funded from state budgets, notified separately, and often capped and time-limited.

A few examples that have been notified or published by state agencies:

State	Indicative state top-up	Notes
Uttar Pradesh	Rs. 15,000 per kW, up to Rs. 30,000	Administered via UPNEDA; over and above the central CFA
Tamil Nadu	Rs. 5,000 / 10,000 / 22,000 for 1 / 2 / 3+ kW	Under G.O. 102 (Sept 2026); registration on or after 5 Aug 2026; first 1 lakh applicants
Gujarat	Up to about Rs. 20,000 (SURYA-Gujarat scheme)	Disbursed through the state's own scheme
Kerala	Around Rs. 14,000 (Soura scheme)	Administered via ANERT
Haryana	Income-linked, roughly Rs. 15,000 - 25,000	Administered via HAREDA

Amounts, eligibility and budgets for state top-ups change frequently, and several states have revised them during 2026. Always confirm your state's current offer on the National Portal's state-scheme section and with your State Nodal Agency before you commit.

How to check your state's stack

Log in to pmsuryaghar.gov.in and open the state-scheme section for your profile. Many states integrate their top-up with the National Portal, so the eligibility and amount appear against your application. If yours does not, ask your State Nodal Agency directly — the contacts are in Part 7.

PART 5

Protecting yourself

17. The 2026 scam landscape

Where government money flows, fraud follows. The solar boom has produced a predictable set of scams, and knowing them is the best protection.

The scam	How it works	The tell
Fake approval SMS	A message claims your subsidy is approved and asks you to click a link or pay a small fee	Official messages do not come from ordinary 10-digit numbers or ask for fees
Lookalike portal	A clone of pmsuryaghar.gov.in harvests your Aadhaar and bank details	The only official site is pmsuryaghar.gov.in
Upfront 'processing' fee	A caller offers to 'release' or 'reserve' your subsidy for a payment	The scheme is free. No fee, ever
Non-ALMM substitution	A vendor quotes an approved model, then installs a cheaper unlisted one	Verify the model number on the MNRE ALMM list, and again on the nameplate
Vanishing vendor	A large advance is collected, then the installer disappears	Never pay a large advance; verify registration and office
Fake 'government' agent	Someone claims to be from MNRE or your DISCOM and demands payment	Government officials do not collect payments from you

If you are targeted

Report a fraudulent link or message at cybercrime.gov.in or call the cyber-crime helpline on **1930** immediately — the faster you call, the higher the chance the money is frozen. For a vendor dispute, use the National Consumer Helpline on **1915**. The full escalation ladder is in the next chapter.

18. Red flags and vendor accountability

The government has responded to vendor fraud with a formal enforcement framework. Knowing how it works tells you what to demand from your vendor, and what the system will do if they fail.

In 2026 MNRE notified a standard operating procedure for vendor violations. Complaints against vendors are processed through the portal's grievance system, third-party field inspections, and high-priority escalations. A vendor that ignores a complaint gets an alert, then a reminder, then a show-cause notice; failure to respond within the cycle triggers a one-month deactivation from the National Portal. The names of deactivated vendors are displayed publicly, and vendors that hoard applications beyond their capacity are also being deactivated.

A list of red flags to keep in mind

- "We are from the government."
- "The subsidy closes tonight — pay now."
- "Only cash accepted."
- "No need to check the portal."
- "We guarantee a zero bill from day one."
- "No inspection required."
- "We will handle everything, you do not need documents."
- A demand for full payment before feasibility approval.
- A quotation far below every other quote.
- A request to pay into a personal account.

The five-minute verification that prevents most fraud

Before paying any advance: (1) confirm the vendor on the portal's list for your DISCOM; (2) check their GST and registered address; (3) get a written quotation with exact model numbers; (4) verify those models on the MNRE ALMM list yourself; (5) agree a payment schedule in writing. If any one of these cannot be satisfied, walk away and use another vendor.

19. Your rights and the grievance ladder

If something goes wrong — a vendor vanishes, the net meter never arrives, a claim is wrongly rejected — you have a defined set of escalation routes. Use them in order, and keep records at every step.

Level	Where to go	What happens
1	National Portal grievance system (pmsuryaghar.gov.in)	Your complaint is logged and the vendor is notified
2	MNRE national helpline: 1800-180-3333, or 15555	The vendor's empanelment status can be reviewed
3	CPGRAMS (pgportal.gov.in), Ministry of New and Renewable Energy	A formal government grievance, monitored to resolution
4	Your DISCOM's nodal officer	Can trigger inspection holds and vendor action
5	National Consumer Helpline: 1915	Consumer mediation and refund orders
6	Cyber-crime portal / 1930 (for online fraud)	For fraud involving payments or data

Keep your evidence

Before you escalate, collect your invoices, the quotation, your portal application ID, bank transfer proof, and any WhatsApp or call records. A complaint with documents moves faster than a complaint without them. Note that if a vendor is unresponsive for more than 30 days after feasibility approval, you can cancel the vendor selection on the portal and choose another registered vendor without losing your place.

PART 6

After installation

20. Maintenance, warranty and the five-year contract

Solar is a low-maintenance asset, not a no-maintenance one. A little care keeps generation close to its peak for two and a half decades.

Cleaning. Dust, bird droppings and pollution cut generation. In most of India, cleaning the panels every two to four weeks keeps output high. Clean in the early morning, not on a hot afternoon.

Monitoring. Check your inverter's display or app monthly. A sudden drop in generation usually means dirt, a fault, or a shutdown.

The five-year maintenance obligation. Under the MNRE vendor framework, registered vendors carry a comprehensive maintenance obligation. Get the terms in writing and keep them with your warranty documents.

Warranties. Modules typically carry a performance warranty of about 25 years and a product warranty of around 10; inverters usually 5 to 10. Keep the certificates.

Insurance. A rooftop system is an asset worth lakhs. Consider adding it to your home insurance so theft or storm damage is covered.

Do not clean panels with hard water or a pressure washer

Hard-water residue leaves a film that reduces output, and high-pressure spraying can damage the module seal and void the warranty. Use soft water and a soft brush or cloth. Your installer should explain this on handover — the scheme guidelines require them to educate you on maintenance and safety.

21. Monitoring, maximising and earning from surplus

A system that is monitored and correctly sized earns twice: it cuts your bill and it can pay you for what you export.

The National Portal receives generation data from connected inverters and smart meters, so you can track your own output over time. Under the scheme, more than 12 lakh households earned about Rs. 421 crore in FY 2024-25 from selling surplus power — an average of around Rs. 3,500 a year for those exporting. That is not a business, but it is a real return on capacity you would otherwise have left unused.

Getting the most from your system

Shift heavy loads to daylight. Running the washing machine, water pump or dishwasher while the sun is up uses your own power directly, which is worth more than exporting it.

Keep the roof clear. Do not let new construction, water tanks or trees shade the panels later. Shading is the most common cause of a generation shortfall.

Read your bill with the net meter. Understand what you import, what you export, and what you are credited. If the numbers look wrong, query your DISCOM early.

Consider a modest battery later. If outages matter to you, a battery hybrid can be added, but it changes the economics — size it for backup, not for savings.

The honest expectation

A right-sized system should bring your electricity bill close to zero, and occasionally earn you a small credit. It will not usually make you rich. The value is in the twenty-five years of reduced bills and protection against rising tariffs.

22. When you move, sell or rent

Solar systems outlive most people's stay in a house, so it is worth knowing what happens to the asset when circumstances change.

Selling the house. A rooftop system and the lower bills it produces can add to a property's appeal. Be ready to hand over the warranty documents and explain the net-metering arrangement to the buyer.

The connection is tied to the property. The subsidy and the net-metering arrangement attach to the electricity connection and the premises, not to you personally. A new owner generally inherits the benefit.

Renting out the house. If you rent the property, the tenant usually pays the electricity bill and therefore enjoys the lower bills. Factor that into your rent, or agree how the benefit is shared.

Shifting home. Panels can sometimes be relocated, but a subsidy claimed on one connection cannot be transferred to a new property, and reinstallation has its own costs. Treat a move as a reason to sell the system with the house where possible.

Keep the file

Whatever happens, keep one folder — physical or digital — with the invoice, the ALMM-verified model numbers, the warranty documents, the commissioning certificate and the net-metering agreement. It is the system's identity, and you will want it at every transition.

PART 7

Tools and deep dives

23. The vendor quote teardown

A solar quote is a small document that hides a lot. Two quotes for the same 3 kW system can differ by a lakh, and the difference is almost never in the panels. Here is what a serious quote contains — and what a careless one leaves out.

Line in the quote	What a fair quote states	What a bad quote hides
Modules	Exact brand, model number, wattage, ALMM listing	"Tier-1 panels", no model number
Inverter	Exact brand, model, capacity, certification	"High-efficiency inverter"
Structure	Material (galvanised), height, tilt	"Mounting structure"
Cabling & safety	DC/AC cable spec, earthing, surge protection	Not mentioned
Net metering	Who files it and who chases the DISCOM	"We will handle it"
Warranties	Module, inverter and workmanship terms	"Full warranty"
Payment	Milestones tied to delivery and commissioning	"70% advance to book"
Maintenance	The five-year comprehensive maintenance obligation	Not mentioned

Reading the price

A fair price in 2026 is roughly Rs. 50,000 to Rs. 70,000 per kW installed, depending on state, roof and brand. Small systems cost more per kW because fixed costs spread over fewer watts; a 1 kW system often lands near the top of the range. If a quote is far below every other quote, the saving has to come from somewhere — cheaper panels, a flimsier structure, or corners on safety.

Ask for the model numbers in writing

The single most useful thing you can do before signing is ask for the exact module and inverter model numbers in writing, then verify both against the current MNRE ALMM list yourself. It takes ten minutes and it protects a Rs. 78,000 subsidy.

24. The twelve rejection traps

Almost every failed subsidy claim fails for one of a dozen predictable reasons. Each is avoidable, and each is cheaper to avoid than to fix.

#	The trap	The fix
1	Installing before feasibility approval	Wait for approval (or deemed approval) on the portal first
2	Using an unregistered vendor	Choose only from the portal's vendor list for your DISCOM
3	Non-ALMM modules or cells installed	Verify exact model numbers on the MNRE ALMM list, before and at delivery
4	Name mismatch between Aadhaar and the electricity bill	Correct the bill name at your DISCOM before applying
5	Wrong DISCOM selected on the portal	Copy the DISCOM name exactly from your bill
6	Consumer number entered incorrectly	Type it exactly as printed — no added spaces or dashes
7	Bank account not Aadhaar-seeded	Check DBT linkage before you apply, or the payment will fail
8	System larger than your sanctioned load	Use the automatic load enhancement up to 10 kW, or apply for enhancement
9	Missing commissioning certificate	Chase the net meter; the certificate follows it
10	Failure to upload geo-tagged photos	Make sure your vendor uploads them from your portal login
11	Off-grid system installed	Choose a grid-connected (or approved hybrid) system
12	Prior subsidy already claimed on the same connection	Confirm the connection is clean before you start

Notice the pattern

Eight of the twelve traps are paperwork or sequence errors, not technical faults. That is the whole lesson of this playbook: the subsidy is lost far more often to a missing step than to a bad panel.

25. Solar for flats, societies and shared terraces

If you live in a flat, you are not excluded. You simply have a different route — and it is worth understanding before you assume solar is for independent houses only.

There are two ways a flat owner can go solar. The first is an individual system, where you have terrace or roof rights and install your own plant on your allotted area. The second is a society-level system for common facilities, installed by the Resident Welfare Association or Apartment Owners Association.

Route	Who applies	What qualifies
Individual flat owner	The owner, with terrace or roof rights	A standard residential system on the allotted area
Society / RWA, common facilities	The RWA or AOA	Rs. 18,000 per kWp up to 500 kWp, roughly 3 kWp per house

Group net metering and virtual net metering arrangements can qualify for the subsidy where the installation is on a roof, terrace or balcony and the metering arrangement is approved by the DISCOM. The society's connection under this route must be dedicated to common facilities and not used to supply individual flats.

What to raise at the next society meeting

A common-facility system under PM Surya Ghar can cut the society's shared electricity bill — lifts, water pumps, corridor lighting, and now EV charging. The subsidy is Rs. 18,000 per kWp up to 500 kWp, roughly 3 kWp per household. The RWA or AOA applies; the benefit accrues to common funds.

26. Your twenty-five year savings picture

A solar system is a long-lived asset, and the honest way to judge it is over its whole life rather than the first year. The table below is an illustration for a 3 kW system with a net cost of about Rs. 1,02,000 after subsidy, an annual saving of about Rs. 34,560, and a 3 percent annual rise in tariffs. It is a planning estimate, not a promise — your numbers will differ.

Year	Cumulative saving	Net cost recovered?
1	Rs. 34,560	Not yet
3	Rs. 106,822	Yes
5	Rs. 183,484	Yes
10	Rs. 396,192	Yes
15	Rs. 642,778	Yes
20	Rs. 928,640	Yes
25	Rs. 1,260,032	Yes

Illustrative only, assuming a 3% annual tariff escalation and no major repair costs. Actual savings depend on your tariff, generation and consumption.

What the table is telling you

The net cost is recovered within the first few years. After that, the system is effectively free electricity plus a small income from surplus. Even with conservative assumptions, a well-chosen system returns several times its net cost over its warranted life — which is why the government's own calculations run over 25 years.

The two assumptions that matter most

First, **generation**: a shadow-free, well-maintained roof produces close to the estimates; a shaded or dusty one does not. Second, **tariff growth**: the higher your future tariff, the better solar looks, because you are buying your own power at today's cost.

27. The ninety-day action plan

Here is the whole process compressed into a plan you can actually follow. Most of it is waiting on other people; your job is to keep each step moving.

When	What you do	The point
Week 1	Check eligibility, read your bill, decide your system size	Know your numbers before anyone sells to you
Week 1-2	Gather documents; fix any Aadhaar-bill name mismatch	Prevents the most common rejection
Week 2	Register and apply on pmsuryaghar.gov.in	Starts the clock and generates your e-token
Week 2-3	Get at least three quotes from registered vendors	Lets you compare like for like
Week 3	Verify ALMM model numbers; sign a written contract	Protects the subsidy and your safety
Week 3-5	Installation	One to three days of actual work
Week 5	Update the portal; upload geo-tagged photos	Moves the file to the DISCOM
Week 5-9	Chase inspection and net-meter installation	The stage that delays most claims
Week 9-11	Upload the commissioning certificate and bank details	Triggers the subsidy
Week 11-13	Subsidy credited; set up monitoring and maintenance	The system starts earning

The one habit that makes this plan work

Log in to the portal and read your own application status at least once a week. Know which stage you are at, and who owes the next action. The people who get their subsidy on time are the ones who track their own file.

PART 8

Reference

28. Frequently asked questions

Who can apply for PM Surya Ghar?

Any Indian residential household with a valid grid-connected electricity connection from its local DISCOM, that owns or holds rights to the rooftop. There is no income limit.

How much subsidy do I get?

Rs. 30,000 per kW for the first two kW, plus Rs. 18,000 for the third kW, capped at Rs. 78,000 for any system of 3 kW or larger. Special-category states get higher rates.

Is the subsidy deducted from the price?

No. You pay the full system cost up front, and the subsidy is credited to your bank account (or loan account) after commissioning. Budget for the full cost.

How long does the subsidy take?

MNRE processes it within 15 days of DISCOM approval. End to end, most people receive it within roughly 60 to 90 days of applying.

Do I need to install before or after applying?

Always apply and get feasibility approval first. Installing before approval can disqualify you from the subsidy.

What is the maximum system size?

Residential systems up to 10 kW get deemed feasibility and automatic load enhancement. Larger systems are possible but need a manual feasibility study and may need an inspector's sign-off.

Does a bigger system get a bigger subsidy?

No. The central subsidy is capped at Rs. 78,000 from 3 kW upward. A 10 kW system gets the same central subsidy as a 3 kW one.

Can I use any installer?

No. To claim the subsidy, the installation must be done by a vendor registered on the National Portal, using ALMM-listed modules.

What is ALMM and why does it matter?

ALMM is the MNRE's Approved List of Models and Manufacturers. Your modules must be on it. From 1 June 2026, List-II (solar cells) also applies. Non-compliant equipment fails inspection and forfeits the subsidy.

Is the scheme free to apply?

Yes. Registration and application are free. Anyone charging a processing or reservation fee is running a scam.

Can I get a loan?

Yes. Collateral-free loans up to Rs. 2 lakh at about 5.75% p.a. are available from public-sector banks, applied for through the Jan Samarth portal after National Portal registration.

How does the subsidy interact with a loan?

The subsidy is applied first to the loan account up to the outstanding amount; any remainder goes to your bank account.

Does off-grid solar qualify?

No. Pure off-grid systems do not get the subsidy. Grid-connected (and, subject to approval, behind-the-meter hybrid) systems do.

What if my DISCOM has paused new connections?

Some congested urban grids have imposed moratoriums. Check with your DISCOM before committing.

Can a housing society or RWA apply?

Yes, for common facilities including EV charging, at Rs. 18,000 per kWp up to 500 kWp, roughly 3 kWp per house.

Will it really make my bill zero?

For a household consuming up to about 300 units a month, a right-sized system with net metering can broadly wipe out the bill. Bills will not be zero if you consume far more than you generate.

Can I earn from surplus power?

Yes, where your state allows it. Over 12 lakh households earned about Rs. 421 crore in FY 2024-25 from exporting surplus — around Rs. 3,500 a year for those exporting.

How much roof do I need?

Roughly 100 square feet of shadow-free roof per kW — about 300 sq ft for a 3 kW system.

How much does a system generate?

About 4 units per kW per day, or roughly 120 units per kW per month in most of India, depending on location and shading.

What is the payback?

For a typical 3 kW system, roughly 3 to 4 years after subsidy, given the panels' 25-year life.

Do I need to clean the panels?

Yes. Every two to four weeks in most of India. Clean in the early morning with soft water, never a pressure washer.

Is there a maintenance contract?

Registered vendors carry a comprehensive maintenance obligation under the MNRE framework. Get the terms in writing.

What if the vendor vanishes?

Escalate through the portal's grievance system, then the MNRE helpline, then CPGRAMS and the consumer helpline. Deactivated vendors are publicly listed.

Can I change my vendor?

Yes. If your vendor is unresponsive for over 30 days after feasibility approval, you can cancel the selection on the portal and choose another registered vendor without losing your place.

What documents do I need?

Aadhaar, your latest electricity bill, bank details and cancelled cheque, property ownership proof, an Aadhaar-linked mobile for OTP, and a photograph. PAN if you take a loan.

What is the name-match rule?

The name on your Aadhaar must match the name on your electricity bill. Mismatches cause automated rejection — fix them before applying.

What is the e-token?

A token generated when you apply, redeemed after commissioning to release your subsidy. It is visible on your portal profile.

Do state subsidies exist?

Yes, in several states. Amounts vary and change often. Check the state-scheme section on the portal and your State Nodal Agency.

When does the scheme end?

The scheme's guidelines run until 31 March 2027, with a target of one crore households. Subsidy is paid from a fixed budget, first-come, first-served.

What is the single biggest mistake to avoid?

Choosing an unregistered vendor, or installing before feasibility approval. Either can cost you the entire subsidy.

29. Glossary and state nodal agencies

Glossary

Term	Meaning
CFA	Central Financial Assistance — the central subsidy
DISCOM	Your electricity distribution company
Net metering	Crediting your exported surplus against your consumption
Bidirectional meter	The net meter that measures both import and export
ALMM	Approved List of Models and Manufacturers (List-I modules, List-II cells)
DCR	Domestic Content Requirement for subsidised modules
kWp	Kilowatt peak — the rated DC capacity of your panels
Benchmark cost	The reference cost MNRE uses to calculate the subsidy
e-token	The portal token redeemed to release your subsidy
SNA	State Nodal Agency for renewable energy
Jan Samarth	The government's single-window loan portal

State Nodal Agencies (a selection)

State	Nodal agency
Gujarat	Gujarat Energy Development Agency (GEDA)
Haryana	Haryana Renewable Energy Development Agency (HAREDA)
Kerala	ANERT
Tamil Nadu	TEDA / TANGEDCO
Uttar Pradesh	UPNEDA

Your State Nodal Agency and DISCOM are the authoritative sources for your state's rules, top-up subsidies and net-metering terms. The National Portal lists the vendor and grievance contacts for your area.

30. Sources

Every figure and rule in this playbook was drawn from official or primary sources. Where amounts change, verify against these before you commit.

Government sources

Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) — *Guidelines for PM-Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana* (Central Financial Assistance to Residential Consumers), and scheme web pages at mnre.gov.in.

National Portal for Rooftop Solar — pmsuryaghar.gov.in (application, vendor lists, state schemes, grievance system).

Press Information Bureau (PIB) releases on PM Surya Ghar, including installation milestones, subsidy disbursed, and scheme simplifications (2026).

Ministry of Power — Electricity (Rights of Consumers) Rules, 2020 and the 2021 Amendment Rules (deemed feasibility; net-metering limits).

State Nodal Agencies and state schemes: UPNEDA, TEDA/TANGEDCO (G.O. 102, September 2026), GEDA (SURYA-Gujarat), HAREDA, ANERT.

Bank and financing sources

State Bank of India, Bank of Baroda, Canara Bank, Union Bank of India, PNB and other public-sector bank PM Surya Ghar loan pages (rate sheets, 2026).

Jan Samarth portal (jansamarth.in) — the government's single-window loan application route.

A final word

The scheme is generous, the process is now mostly online, and the deadline is real. Do the four things that matter: verify your documents, choose a registered vendor, never pay a large advance, and track your own application. Get those right and the rest — a lower bill and a subsidy in your bank — follows.

The Rooftop Solar Playbook — PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana, India 2026-27 Edition. Published by digitalkartai.shop. Compiled from official sources, October 2026. Verify current subsidy amounts and rules on the official portal before committing to a purchase.